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B1 Grammar Summary – Level 6





Consolidation of present and future tenses

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

Present simple
The present simple is used to talk about:
habits or routines that happen every day
facts that are always true
likes and dislikes.
In the third person singular form (*he, she, it*), the letter *-s* is added to the infinitive.
The auxiliary verb *do / does* is used in the negative and interrogative forms.

I work in a hospital. **He speaks French.** **She likes jogging.**

I don't work in a hospital. **Does he speak French?**

Present continuous
The present continuous is used to talk about actions that are happening now.

I'm working in a hospital this week. **She's driving home right now.**

It can also be used to talk about definite arrangements for the future. These arrangements usually involve other people and a specific place and time in the future.

I'm working late tonight. **She's driving to the beach later.**

***going to* future**
The structure *to be* + *going to* + infinitive is used to talk about plans or decisions that have already been made, or intentions.

I'm going to buy a car next month. **She's going to get married in May.**

The *going to* future is also used to make predictions when there is some evidence at the moment of speaking that an event or action will happen.

He's driving too fast. He's going to crash.

***will* future**
The structure *will* + infinitive is used to make a decision at the time we are speaking.

The phone is ringing. I'll answer it. **It's raining. I'll take an umbrella.**

The structure *will* + infinitive is also used to make predictions about something we feel sure will happen in the future.
The contraction of *will* is *'ll*. All subjects take the same form.

I'm sure he'll call me tonight. **I know they'll be hungry later.**

Reflexive pronouns

Read the explanations. Then click on the words and sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

Reflexive pronouns are used when the subject and the object of the sentence are the same person.

I hurt myself. **She cut herself.** **They burnt themselves.**

If the sentence contains a different object, a reflexive pronoun is not used in English.

I hurt my leg. **She cut her finger.** **They burnt their hands.**

subject pronoun	reflexive pronoun
I	myself
you	yourself
he / she / it	himself / herself / itself
we	ourselves
you	yourselves
they	themselves

Note the difference of meaning in the following sentences:

John poured Anna a cup of coffee. **John poured himself a cup of coffee.**

He hurt his little brother. **He hurt himself.**

These pronouns can also be used to emphasize who did the action. When they are used in this way, they are called emphatic pronouns.

He repaired his bike himself. **They built their house themselves.**

Note! The verb *enjoy* can be reflexive in English.

I enjoyed myself. ~~I enjoyed.~~

Note! These verbs are not reflexive in English:

She had a shower and got dressed. **He shaves every morning.**

Did you get up late?Please sit down.

They met last night.

Consolidation of past tenses

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

Past simple
The past simple is used to describe finished actions in the past.

I bought a new jacket yesterday. He went out last night.

Note! The auxiliary verb did is used for the negative and interrogative forms of the past simple.

Sentences in the past simple usually include expressions which specify when the action took place.

I didn't have breakfast this morning. Did Sam play golf last weekend?
~~I no have breakfast this morning.~~ ~~Sam played golf last weekend?~~

Past continuous
The past continuous is used to describe actions in progress at a particular time in the past. The exact times the action started and finished are not known or are not important.

Time expressions
For is used with both the past simple and the past continuous to indicate how long an action lasted.

He lived in London for four years. **I was staying with friends for a week.**

During + noun is used with both the past simple and the past continuous to indicate the period in which an action took place.

I woke up twice during the night. **We weren't listening during the class.**

When is used in a sentence which contains two distinct actions which occurred in the past.
If they are short consecutive actions, then both verbs are in the past simple.
If one action took place while the other was occurring, then the shorter action is in the past simple, and the longer action is in the past continuous.

He ran when he saw her. **I cried when he was leaving.**

While is usually used with the past continuous, not the past simple.

We saw a ghost while we were staying at that hotel.

Consolidation of the present perfect

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

The present perfect is used to talk about actions which happened in the past but are connected to the present.

I've broken my leg. **She hasn't passed her exams.**

The present perfect is used with *ever* and *never* to talk about experiences that people have or have not had at an unspecified time in the past.

Have you ever ridden a camel? **I've never been abroad.**

The adverbs *for* and *since* can be used with the present perfect to talk about actions which started in the past and continue now. *For* refers to the period of time and *since* refers to the moment when the period began.

I've had my car for six months. **I've known her for ages.**

She's lived here since May.

Note! The present simple is never used in English to talk about actions which started in the past and continue now.

I've been in Spain since June. She's had the same job for a year.
~~I am in Spain since June.She has the same job for a year.~~

Just is used with the present perfect to say that something happened only a short time ago. It is usually used in affirmative sentences.
Already is used to say that something has finished earlier than expected, and before the time of speaking. It is usually used in affirmative sentences.
Yet is used to say an event or action has not happened until now, even though it was expected. It is used in negative sentences and questions.

I've just arrived home. She's already left. Have you had lunch yet?

Note! The past simple is used with time expressions like yesterday, ago, last night and in 2007.

I went to London yesterday. I lived in France two years ago.
~~I've been to London yesterday.I've lived in France two years ago.~~

It is also used in questions with when and what time.

When did you visit Paris? What time did you arrive in Rome?
~~When have you visited Paris?What time have you arrived in Rome?~~

both and *neither*, *all* and *none*, *each* and *one*

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

both* and *neither

Both and *neither* are used to refer to two people or things.
Both is used with a noun and a plural verb. *Neither* is used with a noun and a singular verb. Notice that an affirmative verb is used in both cases.

Both contestants are good at maths. Neither contestant is bad at spelling.

Both of and *neither of* can be used with a pronoun (*us, you, them*) or a determiner and a noun (*my parents, the boys*, etc.). The verb after *neither of* is always in the affirmative.

Both of you are good at maths. **Neither of my parents is at home.**

all*, *no* and *none

All and *no* refer to a group of people or things. *All* is used with plural nouns, and *no* is used with singular nouns.

All contestants are nervous. **No contestant has seen the cards.**

All of and *none of* are used with a pronoun (*us, you, them*) or a determiner and a noun (*my family, the answers*, etc.). The verb can be in the singular or the plural.

All of my family is at the wedding. **None of the answers are right.**

Note! The word *of* is often omitted between *all* and the noun.

All the contestants are nervous.

each* and *one

Each refers to every individual thing or person within a group. One refers to only one thing or person in a group. It is used with a singular noun and a singular verb.

Each contestant answered three questions.

One contestant is a pilot.

Each of and *one of* can be used with a pronoun (*us, you, them*), or a determiner and a noun (*your books, the numbers*, etc.). The verb is always in the singular.

I listened to each of his questions. **He missed out one of the numbers.**

Frequency adverbs and expressions

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences and expressions in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

The frequency adverbs *always, usually, often, sometimes, hardly ever* and *never* are used to say how often something happens.

Frequency adverbs are usually placed before the main verb in the affirmative. However, they are always placed after the verb *to be*.

We never work together. **I'm hardly ever ready at 9 o'clock.**

Frequency adverbs are usually placed between the auxiliary and the main verb in negative sentences.

We didn't often go out.

In interrogative sentences, frequency adverbs are usually placed after the subject..

Does he usually fly to Germany? **Have you always been a pilot?**

The most common position for *sometimes* is at the beginning of a sentence.

Sometimes we fly to Canada.

Frequency expressions are usually placed at the end of a sentence. The following expressions are used to say how many times something happens in a period of time.
Note that *once* and *twice* are irregular.

once a week **twice a month** **three times a year**

The expressions *all the time, most of the time* and *some of the time* are used to say approximately how often something happens.

I speak English all the time at work. **I'm late some of the time.**

Questions about frequency are asked in the following way:

How often do you go abroad? **Do you ever travel by train?**

How often did you go running? **Have you ever missed your flight?**

want (somebody to do something)

Read the explanations. Then click on the words and sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

***want* + noun**
We use the verb *want* + noun to express what we desire.

I want a car. **She doesn't want a salad.**

***want* + infinitive**
The structure *want* + infinitive is used to express what we would like to do.

I want to drive. **She doesn't want to have lunch.**

Note! *To* alwayscomes before the infinitive.

He wants to leave work early. ~~He wants leave work early.~~

***want* + person + infinitive**
This structure is used when we want someone else to do something:
want + a person's name / an object pronoun + infinitive

Anna wants Mike to make her a salad. **Do you want me to drive?**

subject pronoun	object pronoun
I	me
you	you
he / she / it	him / her / it
we	us
you	you
they	them

Note! In English, the verb after *want* is always in the infinitive.

He wants her to finish the report. ~~He wants that she finishes the report.~~

The same construction is also used for *would like*:
would like + a person's name / an object pronoun + infinitive

Would you like me to make some tea? **I'd like you to look after this key.**

Infinitive patterns

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

Infinitive of purpose
Infinitives with the preposition *to* are used to give the reason why somebody does something. They are called *infinitives of purpose.*

He's made an appointment to see the doctor.

They'll call you to tell you the results.

She drives home to save time.

I'm going to France to learn French.

We went to their house to look after their children.

Note! The word *for* is never used with verbs to express purpose.

We went to the town centre to buy some clothes.
~~We went to the town centre for to buy some clothes.~~

Adjective + infinitive
The infinitive is used after certain adjectives in English.

I'm glad to hear your news. **He's difficult to understand.**

The pattern *too* + adjective + infinitive can also be used.

I'm too tired to go out. **They're too excited to sleep.**

Indefinite pronoun + infinitive
The infinitive is often used after indefinite pronouns, such as *something, anything*, etc.

She wants something to eat. **We didn't have anything to do.**

The old lady has nobody to talk to. **They asked everyone to come.**

Note! In negative sentences *anything* is used instead of *nothing.*

We didn't have anything to drink. ~~We didn't have nothing to drink.~~

tell and *say*

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

The verbs tell and say are used to instruct someone what to say to another person.

tell
The verb tell is always used with an object. The word that can either follow the object or be omitted:

tell + object + (that)

Tell his mother that he's OK.

Tell his parents we've found him.

Tell her that he's OK.

Tell them we've found him.

The verb tell is often used in the expressions tell a story, tell lies and tell the truth.

She tells stories about the past.

Oscar's always telling lies.

Adele never tells the truth.

say
The verb say is used without an object. The word that can either follow the verb say or be omitted:
say + (that)

Say that there's a man on the roof.

Say the man is dangerous.

Note! Say is never used with an object.

Tell them we need some help.
~~Say them we need some help.~~

Say is used in the expressions say hello, say goodbye and say sorry.

Say hello to the police officer.

Say goodbye to the doctor.

Say sorry to your friend.

tell / ask (somebody to do something)

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

We use this structure to order someone to do something:

tell + person's name / object pronoun + *to* infinitive

Tell Sam to be careful.

We told them to hurry up.

We use this structure to ask someone to do something:

ask + person's name / object pronoun + *to* infinitive

Ask Matt to call me.

We asked them to wait for us.

They asked me to book a table.

Note! The main verb is always the infinitive with *to*.

Tell him to put his hands in the air. ~~Tell him that he puts his hands in the air.~~

I asked Sally to send me an email. ~~I asked that Sally sent me an email.~~

To give orders in the negative, the word *not* is placed before the infinitive of the main verb:

tell / ask + person's name / object pronoun + *not* + *to* infinitive

Tell him not to shoot.

They told us not to wait.

We told Hannah not to tell Mike.

Ask him not to talk so loudly.

They asked us not to make a noise.

I asked Lucy not to finish the report.

Note! We use *not* and not *didn't* to make the sentence negative.

She told me not to go into the building.
~~She told me that I didn't go into the building.~~

She asked him not to be late.
~~She asked that he wasn't late.~~

may and *might*

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

may and might

We use may and might + infinitive to make predictions about the future which we think are possible but not certain.

Tom may speak to a police officer. Sarah might meet a pilot.

I may go to Paris next August. She might study accountancy.

Note! To is never used after may or might.

We may drive to the city centre or we might go by bus.

~~We may to drive to the city centre or we might to go by bus.~~

The structure may not and might not + infinitive are used to make predictions about the future which we think will possibly not happen.

She might not arrive on time. He may not go on holiday this year.

Note! We can contract *might not* to *mightn't* but we usually use the full form. We cannot contract *may not*.

I may not move to London. ~~I mayn't move to London.~~

will / going to

The structure *will* + infinitive can be used to make predictions about something we feel sure will happen in the future.

She'll meet a man in a uniform. **They won't be ready on time.**

The *going to* future is usually used to make predictions when there is some evidence at the moment of speaking that an event or action will happen.

I can see the postman. He's going to knock on our door.

Look at those men. They're going to rob the bank.



Adjectives and adverbs of probability

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

Adjectives
sure and certain
The adjectives sure and certain mean the same in English (100% confident of something). Note that both adjectives can be followed by that:
to be + sure / certain + (that)

I'm sure that you'll meet a stranger.

I'm not certain they'll get married.

possible, impossible, likely and unlikely
To say how probable it is that something will happen, we can use it's + :
possible (could happen)
impossible (cannot happen)
likely (probably will happen)
unlikely (probably will not happen)
Note that these adjectives can also be followed by that:
It's + possible / impossible / likely / unlikely + (that) ...

It's possible I'll win the quiz.

It's unlikely that she'll go to London.

Note! We usually use likely and unlikely when we talk about probability. Probable and improbable are more formal.
It's unlikely that it'll rain tomorrow. ~~It's improbable that it'll rain tomorrow.~~

Adverbs
definitely, probably and possibly
The adverbs definitely (100% will happen), probably (likely to happen) and possibly (could happen) are used in English to indicate how likely we think something is to happen.
In an affirmative sentence, they are placed between the auxiliary verb will and the infinitive of the main verb:
subject + will + definitely / probably / possibly + infinitive (without to)

She'll definitely go on a long journey.

You'll probably meet a police officer.

When they are used in a negative sentence, the adverb is placed between the subject and the auxiliary verb won't:
subject + definitely / probably / possibly + won't + infinitive (without to)

We certainly won't have seven children.

He possibly won't move to a different town.

Note! In English, probably is used with the verb will. The sentence It's probable that ... is rarely used.

I'll probably change my job. ~~It's probable that I'll change my job.~~



First conditional

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

The first conditional is used to refer to an action which will happen if a particular condition is fulfilled.

If I have time, I'll cook dinner. **If it rains, I'll watch a DVD.**

A sentence in the first conditional has two parts.
The first part, the condition, starts with *if: If it rains*.
The second part is the main action: *I'll watch a DVD*. The main action only happens after the condition is fulfilled.

Affirmative and negative
The condition contains the present simple form of the verb after *if* to refer to the future. The main action contains *will / won't* + infinitive.

if + subject + present simple, + subject + *will / won't* + infinitive

If I set my alarm, I'll wake up on time.If it isn't cold, I'll run to work.

If he gets up late, he won't wash up.If I don't set my alarm, I'll oversleep.

Note! We do not normally use will in the if part of the sentence.

If I see her tomorrow, I'll tell her. ~~If I'll see her tomorrow, I'll tell her.~~

We can reverse the two parts of the sentence without affecting the meaning. Note that the comma is omitted if the main action comes first:
subject + will / won't + infinitive + if + subject + present simple

I'll do it tomorrow if I have time. = If I have time, I'll do it tomorrow.

I'll oversleep if I don't set my alarm. = If I don't set my alarm, I'll oversleep.

Interrogative
Questions in the first conditional are formed with will followed by the subject and an infinitive.
We can use a question word at the beginning of the question. The if part is normally placed at the end:
(question word) + will + subject + infinitive + if + present simple ... ?

What will you do if you pass your driving test?

Note! Will is always placed before the subject in the interrogative.

What will he do if he can't go? ~~What he will do if he can't go?~~

Future time clauses with *when, before, after, etc*

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

when, before, after and as soon as
We can use when, before, after and as soon as to join two sentences. They indicate the order in which two actions occur.
The present simple is often used after these words to refer to future time. Will is often used in the main part of the sentence.
subject + will + infinitive + when / before / after / as soon as + subject + present simple

She'll clean the kitchen after she cooks the dinner.

He'll get changed when he gets home.

The two parts of the sentence can be reversed without affecting the meaning. Note that a comma is used after the future time clause:
When / Before / After / As soon as + subject + present simple, + subject + will + infinitive

Before I eat, I'll wash my hands. I'll wash my hands before I eat.

As soon as I arrive, I'll tell her. I'll tell her as soon as I arrive.

Note! Will is not used in a future time clause.

She'll make some lunch when she's hungry.
~~She'll make some lunch when she'll be hungry.~~

Future time clauses with may, might and can
We can use the verbs may, might and can instead of will in the main part of the sentence to express an element of doubt:
subject + may / might / can + infinitive + when / before / after / as soon as + subject + present simple
or
When / Before / After / As soon as + subject + present simple, + subject + may / might / can + infinitive

I may go out after I leave work. When he gets up, he might watch TV.

They can eat as soon as they're ready.

Note! The present continuous or the present perfect can be used instead of the present simple in the future time clause.

She'll clean the house when the children are playing in the park.

After we've had dinner, we might go to the cinema.

Second conditional

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

The second conditional is used to refer to an imaginary or hypothetical situation.

If I had a car, I'd drive to work every day.

A sentence in the second conditional has two parts. The first part, the imaginary situation, starts with *if*: *If I had a car*.
The second part is the main action: *I'd drive to work every day.*

Affirmative and negative sentences
The past simple form of the verb is always used after *if*. The verb *would / wouldn't* + infinitive is used in the main part:
if + subject + past simple, + subject + *would / wouldn't* + infinitive
We can contract *would* to *'d*.

If I won, I'd be excited.

If she moved house, I wouldn't be happy.

The two parts of the sentence can be reversed without affecting the meaning. Note that the comma is omitted if the main action comes first:
subject + *would / wouldn't* + infinitive + *if* + subject + past simple

I'd have a tea if we had some milk. **If we had some milk, I'd have a tea.**

When the verb to be is used after if, we can either use was or were with I, he, she and it:
if + I / he / she / it + was / were ... , subject + would / wouldn't + infinitive

If I were rich, I'd live in a palace. = If I was rich, I'd live in a palace.

If he were six, he'd go to school. = If he was six, he'd go to school.

Note! In the phrase 'if I were you', the verb were is always used, not was.

If I were you, I'd leave your husband. ~~If I was you, I'd leave your husband.~~

Interrogative
Questions in the second conditional are formed with would, the subject and an infinitive.
We can use a question word at the beginning of the question. The if part of the sentence is normally at the end:
(question word) + would + subject + infinitive + if + subject + past simple ... ?

What would you do if a dog bit you? What would you do if you were here?

Note! Would is always placed before the subject in the interrogative.

What would he do if he had a car? ~~What he would do if he had a car?~~



First or second conditional?

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

Meaning
The first conditional is used to refer to an action which will happen if a particular condition is fulfilled. The first conditional refers to a real possibility in the present or the future.

If her son is depressed, she'll take him to the doctor.

The second conditional is used to refer to an imaginary situation. It refers to a situation which is possible but unlikely to happen.

They wouldn't have rows if she wore different clothes.

Form
In first conditional sentences, the condition is expressed by *if* + present simple and the main action by *will / won't* + infinitive.

If Charles remembers, he'll meet us at the cinema.
~~If Charles will remember, he'll meet us at the cinema.~~

In second conditional sentences, the condition is expressed by if + past simple and the main action by would / wouldn't + infinitive.

If the dog was his, he'd give it away.
~~If the dog would be his, he'd give it away.~~

The second conditional can also be used for giving advice.

If I were you, I'd look for a job. If I were you, I wouldn't eat that.

Remember that 'If I were you' is a fixed phrase.

If I were you, I'd buy a new car. ~~If I was you, I'd buy a new car.~~

First conditional or second conditional?
Note the difference of meaning in the following two sentences.
The first conditional is used to talk about a real possibility.

If I run every day, I'll feel healthier.

The second conditional is used to talk about a hypothetical situation.

If I ran every day, I'd feel healthier.

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B1 Grammar Summary – Level 7



Question forms

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

Word order
Questions are usually made by changing the word order of the sentence. The auxiliary verb comes before the subject. The main verb comes after the subject.

Are they working now?

Were you using the printer?

Has she had a coffee break?

Will you phone the office?

Can I borrow your pen?

Could we leave early?

Questions with do / does / did
We place do / does before the subject to make questions in the present simple.

We place did before the subject to make questions in the past simple.

In both cases, the main verb comes after the subject:

Do / Does / Did + subject + main verb ... ?

Does he like his manager?

Do they live in Madrid?

Did she find a job?

Did they finish their work?

Note! In questions in the past simple, remember to use the main verb in the infinitive and never in the past simple form.

Did Ben walk to the office?
~~Did Ben walked to the office?~~

Question words

In questions that start with a question word, we normally use an auxiliary verb before the subject. Again, the main verb is placed after the subject:

question word + auxiliary verb + subject + main verb ... ?

Why are they leaving?

Who were you talking to?

How much have you spent?

When will he call?

Which computer can I use?

What could we do today?

Where does she live?

How did they travel to work?



Questions with *how*

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

We combine how with other words to ask questions about frequency, duration, quantity and distance, and to ask for descriptions.

Frequency

How often do you play golf?

Duration

How long have you worked here?

Note! How long is not followed by the word time.
How long have you lived there?
~~How long time have you lived there?~~

Quantity

How much cheese have we got? How many tomatoes do we need?

Distance

How far is your house from the university?

Note! *How long* is not used to talk about distance. We use *how far*.

How far is Madrid from Granada?
~~How long is Madrid from Granada?~~

Asking for descriptions

How old is your grandmother? **How wide is the river?**

How high is Mount Kilimanjaro? **How big is your new flat?**

How tall is the Empire State Building?

Note! *Tall* is usually used to talk about people and buildings. *High* is usually used to talk about mountains.

How tall are you?
~~How high are you?~~

The gerund (-ing forms)

Read the explanations. Then click on the words and sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

The gerund (the *-ing* form of a verb) is used after certain verbs, after prepositions and as the subject of a sentence.

The gerund after verbs
The gerund is often used after verbs expressing likes and dislikes.

She likes reading romantic fiction. **I love listening to music.**

We enjoyed visiting the museum. **He prefers swimming in the sea.**

They hate watching horror films. **I can't stand flying.**

The gerund is also used after some other verbs:

avoid **consider** **finish**

give up **imagine** **practise**

The gerund is often used after the verb *go* to talk about activities such as sport and recreation.

They're going sailing tomorrow. **We went sightseeing in Tokyo.**

The gerund after prepositions
The gerund is used after prepositions.

Wash your hands before eating. **She's talking about writing a book.**

Note! The infinitive is not used after prepositions.

After visiting Karen, we went for a drink.
~~After to visit Karen, we went for a drink.~~

The gerund as the subject of a sentence
The gerund is often used as the subject of a sentence, especially to talk about an activity in general.

Smoking is bad for your health. **Dancing is good fun.**

Adjectives ending in *–ing* or *-ed*

Read the explanations. Then click on the words and sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

Many adjectives in English end in -ing or -ed.

Adjectives ending in -ing
Adjectives ending in -ing are used to talk about people or things which cause a person to feel something.

This film is very interesting.

Mike's really boring.

The novel was surprising.

Harry's job is very tiring.

Adjectives ending in -ed
Adjectives ending in -ed are used to say how a person feels about something or someone.

I'm very interested in this film.

I'm bored of Mike and his jokes.

She was surprised by the novel.

Harry's very tired after work.

There are lots of pairs of adjectives ending in -ing or -ed.

annoying / annoyed

disappointing / disappointed

embarrassing / embarrassed

exciting / excited

exhausting / exhausted

frightening / frightened

satisfying / satisfied

shocking / shocked

We were disappointed with the play.

The play was disappointing.

The fans were excited.

The match was exciting.

The storm was frightening.

We were frightened by the storm.

The news was shocking.

They were shocked by the news.

Embedded questions (*ask* + if)

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

Word order
Embedded questions with ask + object + if are used to ask someone to get information.
Normally, we change the word order of the sentence to make questions. In embedded questions, the word order of the sentence does not change:

ask + object + if + subject + verb

Are they happy in Paris?	Ask them if they're happy in Paris.
Is she going to live in Italy?	Ask her if she's going to live in Italy.
Has he got a car?	Ask him if he's got a car.
Has she phoned Mike?	Ask her if she's phoned Mike.
Will they help us?	Ask them if they'll help us.
Can he speak Italian?	Ask him if he can speak Italian.

Questions with *do / does / did*
To make normal questions, we use *do / does* before the subject in the present simple and *did* in the past simple. The infinitive of the main verb comes after the subject. In embedded questions, *do / does / did* is not used. The word order is the same as for affirmative sentences.

Do they work on Saturdays?	**Ask them if they work on Saturdays.**

Ask them if do they work on Saturdays.

Does she like swimming?	**Ask her if she likes swimming.**
Did he live in London?	**Ask him if he lived in London.**

Whether can be used instead of *if*.

Has he got any food?	**Ask him whether he's got any food.**
Does she know Lisa?	**Ask her whether she knows Lisa.**

Embedded questions (*ask* + question words)

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

Word order
Embedded questions with ask + object + question word are also used to ask someone to get information.

As for embedded questions with if, in embedded questions with question words, the word order of the sentence does not change:

ask + object + question word + subject + verb

Where is he from?	Ask him where he's from.
When are they going?	Ask them when they're going.
What has she got in that bag?	Ask her what she's got in that bag.
How many cakes has he had?	Ask him how many cakes he's had.
Who will they see later?	Ask them who they'll see later.

Questions with do / does / did
As for embedded questions with ask + if, in embedded questions with ask + a question word, we do not use do / does / did.

When do they leave for Peru?	Ask them when they leave for Peru. ~~Ask them when do they leave for Peru.~~
Which colour does she prefer?	Ask her which colour she prefers.
How much do they charge?	Ask them how much they charge.
What kind of food does he like?	Ask him what kind of food he likes.
What time did she arrive?	Ask her what time she arrived.



Embedded questions

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

Embedded questions with question words

Can you tell me, Could you tell me, Do you know and *Have you any idea* are used with question words to ask for information. In embedded questions, the subject comes before the verb, as in an affirmative sentence:

Can you tell me / Could you tell me / Do you know / Have you any idea + question word + subject + verb ... ?

Where are they from?	**Can you tell me where they're from?**
When is she leaving?	**Could you tell me when she's leaving?**
Why has he got two cars?	**Do you know why he's got two cars?**
What has she bought?	**Have you any idea what she's bought?**
Who will they meet?	**Could you tell me who they'll meet?**
How much can he pay?	**Do you know how much he can pay?**

Note! Remember in embedded questions, we don't use *do / does / did.*

What does she want?	**Do you know what she wants?**
Who did he see?	**Can you tell me who he saw?**

Embedded questions with *if* or *whether*

Again, the subject comes before the verb, as in an affirmative statement. *Whether* can be used instead of *if:*

Can you tell me / Could you tell me / Do you know / Have you any idea + if / whether + subject + verb ... ?

Has he got a meeting?	**Can you tell me if he's got a meeting?**
Is she OK?	**Could you tell me whether she's OK?**
Do they need help?	**Do you know whether they need help?**
Does he work here?	**Could you tell me if he works here?**
Did she phone earlier?	**Have you any idea if she phoned earlier?**



Embedded questions in the past

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

In embedded questions with question words in the past, the past simple or past continuous can be used after the question word. The subject comes before the verb, as in an affirmative sentence:

Did + subject + infinitive + question word + subject + verb in the past simple / past continuous ... ?

Where did she go?	**Did you see where she went?**
When did he leave?	**Did he say when he left?**
Why did they phone?	**Did they tell you why they phoned?**
How much did it cost?	**Did she say how much it cost?**
What were they saying?	**Did you hear what they were saying?**
Who was he texting?	**Did he tell you who he was texting?**

In embedded questions in the past with *if* or *whether*, the past simple or past continuous can be used. Again, the subject comes before the verb, as in an affirmative sentence:

Did + subject + infinitive + *if* / *whether* + subject + verb in the past simple / past continuous ... ?

Was it his van?	**Did he say if it was his van?**
Were they late?	**Did they say whether they were late?**
Was he wearing a coat?	**Did you see if he was wearing a coat?**
Were they seeing clients?	**Did they say if they were seeing clients?**
Did they finish the project?	**Did you hear if they finished the project?**
Did she catch the train?	**Did you see whether she caught the train?**



Present perfect continuous

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

The present perfect continuous can be used to talk about an action that started in the past and continues in the present or has just stopped.

Present perfect continuous (affirmative and negative)
The present perfect continuous is formed using this structure:

subject + *has(n't) / have(n't)* + past participle of *to be* (*been*) + *-ing* form

He's been learning to drive for six weeks.

It's been snowing for hours.

She hasn't been studying much recently.

We've been playing chess since two o'clock.

They haven't been waiting long.

Present perfect continuous (interrogative)
Questions in the present perfect continuous are formed using this structure: question word + *has / have* + subject + past participle of *to be* (*been*) + *-ing* form ... ?

How long has he been looking for a job?

Has she been working much recently?

What have you been doing?

Has it been raining long?

Note! Some verbs such as *have* (to express possession), *know, like, understand* and *want* are not usually used in the continuous form.

How long has Mary had her car?
~~How long has Mary been having her car?~~

I've known him for years.
~~I've been knowing him for years.~~



Present perfect simple or continuous?

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

The present perfect continuous can be used to say how long an action has been continuing for. The action started in the past and continues in the present or has just stopped.

They've been watching this film since eight o'clock.

He's been learning French for two years.

She's been eating cake all day.

The present perfect simple can be used to say how many times we have done something, how many things we have done or how much we have done of something.

They've watched this DVD three times.

He's learnt ten new verbs this week.

How much cake has she eaten?

The present perfect continuous can be used to emphasize the process of an action, especially when it has continued for some time.

I've been reading 'War and Peace' for ages. It's very long!

He's been cleaning the kitchen this morning. He's exhausted.

She's been writing the report all day. She's really busy.

The present perfect simple can be used to say whether or not an action has been completed, with less emphasis on the process of the action. It is often used with the time adverbs *already, just, still* and *yet.*

I've already phoned the office. **I've just finished the last page!**

He still hasn't cleaned the bathroom.

She hasn't written the email yet.

used to

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

Used to + infinitive is used to talk about things that happened regularly in the past but no longer happen, and about past states and situations that no longer exist.

Used to + infinitive is only used to talk about the past. It has no present form.

***used to* (affirmative)**
All subjects take the same form:
subject + *used to* + infinitive

We used to play cricket together when we were children.

She used to live in Madrid but now she lives in Barcelona.

Note! *Used to* + infinitive is not used to talk about things that happen regularly in the present. The present simple is used instead, sometimes with *usually*.

I usually go to the theatre about once a month.
~~I use to go to the theatre about once a month.~~

***used to* (negative)**
All subjects take the same form:

subject + *didn't use to* + infinitive

He didn't use to smoke but now he smokes twenty cigarettes a day.

They didn't use to have a car but now they've got a Ferrari.

***used to* (interrogative)**
All subjects take the same form:

Did + subject + *use to* + infinitive ... ?

Did they use to work here? **Did you use to be a teacher?**

Note! When *used to* + infinitive is used in negative or interrogative sentences, the final letter *-d* is not used.

He didn't use to watch much TV. **Did she use to drive to work?**
~~He didn't used to watch much TV.~~

~~Did she used to drive to work?~~

would

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

Would is used to talk about repeated actions and routines that happened regularly in the past but no longer happen.

subject + *would* + infinitive

When they lived in Paris they would meet for lunch every week.

The children would swim in the sea every summer.

Would + infinitive is not used to talk about past states and situations that no longer exist. We use *used to* instead.

She used to smoke but now she's given up.
~~She would smoke but now she's given up.~~

He used to be a sergeant but now he's an inspector.
~~He would be a sergeant but now he's an inspector.~~

Would + infinitive can be used to talk about someone's routine during a certain period in the past.

When we were children we'd visit our grandparents at the seaside every summer. We'd get up late every morning and then we'd all eat breakfast together. In the afternoon we'd go to the beach and play games. It was fantastic!

In Victorian times, whole families would go to work in the same factory. The hours were long and they would work about ten hours a day. They would have Sundays off, but they would work on Saturdays.

Note! *Would* + infinitive is not used to say how often something happened. The past simple is used instead.

We went skiing three times last year.
~~We would go skiing three times last year.~~

so, neither, nor and *too*

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

so and neither / nor
So and neither / nor can be used before be,have and other auxiliary verbs like can and should to mean 'also'. Be, have or the auxiliary verb is placed before the subject in this case.

so / neither / nor + be, have, can, should, etc. + I

So is used after an affirmative sentence. Neither / nor is used after a negative sentence. Neither and nor have the same meaning.

'I'm from London.' 'So am I.' 'I've got two sisters.' 'So have I.'

'I can come to the meeting.' 'So can I.' 'I should leave soon.' 'So should I.'

'I wasn't very hungry.' 'Neither was I.' '
I hadn't finished.' 'Nor had I.'

'I can't swim.' 'Neither can I.' 'I shouldn't smoke.' 'Nor should I.'

Note! When neither / nor is used, the verb that follows is always in the affirmative form.
'I haven't got any money.' 'Neither have I.'
~~I haven't got any money. Neither haven't I.~~

do / did
If the verb is not be or have and an auxiliary verb is not used before the main verb, do is used after so / neither / nor in the present simple. Did is used in the past simple.

so / neither / nor + do / did + I

'I want to go on holiday.' 'So do I.' '
I don't like cheese.' 'Nor do I.'

'I watched TV last night.' 'So did I.' 'I didn't see him.' 'Neither did I.'

too and neither
Too and neither are used in informal short answers after the pronoun me: Me too, Me neither.

Too is used after an affirmative sentence. Neither is used after a negative sentence.

'I've got three children.' 'Me too.' 'I can't speak Italian.' 'Me neither.'

'I love going to the beach.' 'Me too.' '
I didn't enjoy the film.' 'Me neither.'

'I don't work on Saturdays.' 'Me neither.'
~~I don't work on Saturdays. Me nor.~~

so, neither, nor

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

So and neither / nor can also be used before be,have and other auxiliary verbs like can with other subjects.
so / neither / nor + be,have, can, should, etc. + subject

The verb used after so and neither / nor must agree with the subject which follows.

They haven't got time. Nor has he.You're British and so is she.

She wasn't happy. Neither were
we.We hadn't eaten. Nor had they.

I've been to France and so have you. David can't come. Neither can Joe.

Again, if be, have or an auxiliary verb is not used before the main verb, do / does is used after so / neither / nor in the present simple. Did is used in the past simple.
so / neither / nor + do / does / did + subject

She likes tennis and so do you. They don't read much. Nor does he.

He went to Paris in 2002. So did we.

I didn't go out and neither did they.

Possessive pronouns
So and neither / nor can also be used before be,have and other auxiliary verbs like can with possessive pronouns.
so / neither / nor + be, have, can, should, etc. + mine / yours / his / hers / ours / theirs

The verb used before the possessive pronoun must agree with the subject at the beginning of the sentence.
Her parents are German and so are
mine.

Our office hasn't got a coffee machine. Nor has theirs.

Their children can't swim and neither can ours.

Again, if be, have or an auxiliary verb is not used before the main verb, do / does / did is used after so / neither / nor.

so / neither / nor + do / does / did + mine / yours / his / hers / ours / theirs

My friends don't like skiing and neither do yours.

Your garden looks beautiful in the summer. So does his.

His grandmother didn't work after she got married. Nor did hers.

Expressing reason

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

Because, as and since are used to explain the reason or cause for something. The conjunction because is used before a subject and a verb. It is used when the reason is the most important part of the sentence.
It can be used at the beginning or in the middle of a sentence. When it is used at the beginning of a sentence, the two parts of the sentence are separated by a comma.
Because + subject + verb, + subject + verb
subject + verb + because + subject + verb

Because I'm worried about climate change, I recycle my rubbish.

She didn't go to the party because she had a headache.

He can't come because he's working.

Note! Becauseof is used before a noun or an object pronoun.

Becauseof + noun / object pronoun, + subject + verb
subject + verb + because of + noun / object pronoun
Because of the rain, we didn't play tennis.

He got the job because of her.

The conjunctions as and since are similar to because. They are used when the reason is obvious, or when it is less important than the rest of the sentence. They are also used before a subject and a verb. They can be used at the beginning or in the middle of a sentence. When they are used at the beginning of a sentence, the two parts of the sentence are separated by a comma.
As / Since + subject + verb, + subject + verb
subject + verb + as / since + subject + verb

As the planet is our home, we should look after it.

I'm wearing two jumpers as it's very cold.

Since you didn't reply, we've cancelled your subscription.

You'll have to speak to the manager since you were late.

As and since are not used in short answers. Because or becauseof are used instead.
'Why are you running?' 'Because I'm in a hurry.'
~~'Why are you running?' 'As I'm in a hurry.'~~

~~'Why was the match cancelled?' 'Because it was snowing.'~~
~~'Why was the match cancelled?' 'Since it was snowing.'~~

Expressing contrast

Read the explanations. Then click on the sentences in blue to hear their pronunciation. Listen, repeat and record your voice.

Although, though, even though, in spite of and *despite* are used to express contrast.

Although and *though* have the same meaning. They can be used at the beginning of a sentence or clause that has a verb.

Although / Though + subject + verb, subject + verb

subject + verb, + *although / though* + subject + verb

Though is more common in spoken English than in written English.

Although he studied hard, he didn't pass the exam.

Though I don't really like fruit, I eat it every day.

He was wearing a coat, although the sun was shining.

She loved the film, though she'd never heard of the actors.

Even though is used in the same way as *although* and *though* but it is used to give greater emphasis to the contrast.

Even though he's rich, he hates spending money.

She didn't get the job, even though she was well qualified.

In spite of and *despite* are followed by a noun, pronoun or *-ing* form. They are not followed directly by a sentence or clause that has a verb.
They can be used at the beginning or in the middle of a sentence. When they are used at the beginning of a sentence, the two parts of the sentence are separated by a comma.

In spite of / Despite + noun / pronoun / *-ing* form, + subject + verb
subject + verb + *in spite of / despite* + noun / pronoun / *-ing* form

I went to work on Monday in spite of being unwell.

We saw most of the play despite arriving late.

They played badly. In spite of that, they won the match.

Despite the bad weather, we went camping.